

Muthiah Palaniappan

Reading, UK

Available on request

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Senior Network & Cyber Security Architect and Consultant with over 20 years of experience designing, implementing, and governing complex enterprise network and security solutions across on^oprem, cloud, and hybrid environments. Proven expertise in delivering secure, scalable, and resilient architectures aligned with business strategy, regulatory requirements, and Zero Trust principles.

A seasoned techno^omanagerial leader with a strong track record of leading cross^o functional and global teams, driving large^oscale transformation initiatives, and providing trusted cyber security consulting to senior stakeholders and enterprise customers. Adept at translating business challenges into effective technical solutions while ensuring operational excellence and risk reduction.

Demonstrated success in end^oto^oend project and program delivery, from strategy and architecture definition through implementation and production rollout, consistently achieving high service quality, seamless operations, and customer satisfaction. Passionate about staying at the forefront of emerging technologies and security trends to drive continuous innovation, efficiency, and long^oterm business value.

Skills

- Network Security
- Cloud Technologies
- Zero Trust
- Defense in Depth
- Architecture & Engineering
- Problem-Solving
- Leadership
- Mentoring

Experience

JAN 2015 -

Sr. Network Security Architect / Cognizant, UK

- Design, develop, and implement enterprise network and security architectures across LAN, WAN, SD^oWAN, data centre, and cloud environments (AWS & Azure), aligned with Zero Trust and layered security principles.
- Lead the hands-on design, implementation, and rollout of network infrastructure components including routers, switches, load balancers, and network security solutions such as Firewalls, Web Application Firewalls, endpoint security, and forward/reverse proxy platforms.
- Security solutions Architect for large-scaler Azure migration, leveraging Terraform (IaC) to enforce automated guardrails. Implement a robust multi-layer defence strategy for hybrid Azure environments using Azure Firewall, NSG and ASG's. Enhanced organizational security posture by identifying and remediating critical configuration gaps via Microsoft Defender for Cloud and improving Azure Security score.

- Architect and deliver Secure Access Service Edge (SASE) and Zero Trust solutions for large enterprise environments, providing end-to-end Zscaler architecture and implementation, including Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA) and Zscaler Private Access (ZPA).
- Implement network segmentation strategies using native security controls and third-party tools to enforce Zero Trust and reduce attack surfaces across hybrid and cloud environments.
- Drive legacy network and security transformation initiatives, modernizing outdated technologies to next-generation platforms that meet enterprise scalability, compliance, and long-term technology standards.
- Engineer secure and resilient network solutions that improve operational efficiency, reduce complexity, and enhance the overall security posture of the organization.
- Provide technical leadership and decision-making in support of architecture, strategy, service management, operations, and complex escalation or troubleshooting scenarios.
- Deliver security awareness training for end users and technical enablement sessions for team members on emerging threats, tools, and security best practices.
- Lead and manage offshore operational teams, ensuring service delivery meets defined customer SLAs and operational excellence standards.

OCT 2010 – DEC 2014

Technical Lead / Mindtree, Bangalore

- Act as Technical and Team Lead for offshore Network and Security Services delivery, providing technical direction, governance, and day-to-day operational leadership.
- Design and frame enterprise security and intelligent networking solutions aligned with customer business objectives, operational requirements, and industry best practices.
- Engage with customers to understand pain points and operational challenges, translating requirements into effective, scalable, and secure technical solutions.
- Lead implementation planning and solution integration, providing onsite and offshore support, and validating designed solutions through proof-of-concepts (POC) prior to production deployment.
- Provide Incident and Change Management support using across multiple network and security technologies, including Check Point Firewalls, Cisco ASA, Fortinet Firewalls, Cisco Routers and Switches, and DNS platforms.
- Manage and support incident and change audits, contributing to the creation, review, and enforcement of policies, procedures, and operational standards.
- Ensure process compliance and adherence to organizational, customer, and regulatory requirements across service delivery operations.
- Drive continuous service improvement initiatives within the team to enhance service quality, operational efficiency, and customer satisfaction.

JUNE 2008 – OCT 2010

Sr. Technical Support Engineer/ Net Sol (An IBM Company)

- Remote Infrastructure Management Services (RIMS) supporting multiple enterprise customers, ensuring stable, secure, and SLA-aligned service delivery.
- Provided hands-on engineering and operational support across network and security technologies, including switches, routers, and firewalls.
- Designed, created, and executed change management plans for new service enablement across core switches, routers, and firewall platforms, ensuring minimal risk and service continuity.
- Led integration and greenfield builds of enterprise firewall solutions, including Check Point, Cisco ASA, and Fortinet Firewalls, from design through production deployment.
- Delivered technical presentations and solution walkthroughs to customers on proposed architectures, technologies, and products, supporting decision-making and solution acceptance.

- Provided escalation-level technical support for defined network and security products during deployment and operational phases.
- Led implementation planning and integration activities, offering onsite and offshore support, validating solutions through pre-deployment proofing, and executing final production rollouts within customer environments.

AUG 2006 – MAY 2008

IT Engineer/ CMC Limited, Bangalore

MAY 2005 – AUG 2006

FM Engineer/ HCL Infosystems, Bangalore

Education

2000 -2004

Bachelor of Engineering (Electronics & Instrumentation) / Annamalai University – Chidambaram, TN, India

Certifications

- *ISC2 - Certified in Cyber Security/ 2023*
- *Azure Security Engineer Associate / 2021*
- *AWS Certified Security Specialty / 2020*
- *AWS Certified Solution Architect – Associate*
- *Checkpoint Certified Security Expert*
- *Checkpoint Certified Security Associate*
- *Cisco Certified CCNA & CCNP*